ETORICOXIB

Check BP before starting

Once daily

CHEMICAL NAME 5-chloro-6′-methyl-3-[4-(methylsulfonyl)phenyl]-2,3′-bipyridine

CLASS Selective COX-2 inhibitor (coxib) NSAID

TRADE NAMES Arcoxia · Etorix · Nucoxia

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Osteoarthritis and rheumatoid arthritis.
- Ankylosing spondylitis.
- Acute gouty arthritis.
- Short-term moderate post-operative dental pain.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily, with or without food (faster onset without food).

DOSAGES

- **Osteoarthritis:** 30–60 mg once daily.
- **Rheumatoid arthritis / AS:** 60–90 mg once daily.
- **Acute gout:** 120 mg once daily for max 8 days.
- **Dental pain:** 90 mg once daily for max 3 days.
- Hepatic impairment (moderate): max 30 mg/day.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 25–30 min. **Peak:** 1 h.
- Bioavailability ~100%; metabolised in liver (CYP3A4).
- Excreted in urine. **t½:** about 22 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Highly selective **COX-2** inhibition → anti-inflammatory and analgesic.
- Minimal effect on COX-1, gastric mucosa and platelets.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Dyspepsia, abdominal pain.
- Headache, dizziness, fatigue.
- Oedema, raised BP.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Hypertension (dose-related).
- Myocardial infarction, stroke; heart failure.
- GI bleeding; renal impairment.
- Hypersensitivity reactions.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Uncontrolled hypertension (BP persistently >140/90).
- Ischaemic heart disease, cerebrovascular disease, heart failure (NYHA II–IV).
- Active peptic ulcer; severe hepatic impairment; CrCl <30 mL/min.
- Inflammatory bowel disease; pregnancy and breastfeeding.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Warfarin:** ↑ INR.
- **Rifampicin:** ↓ etoricoxib levels.
- **Diuretics, ACE inhibitors:** ↑ renal risk.
- **Oral contraceptives:** ↑ ethinylestradiol levels.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Measure BP before starting and 2 weeks after, then regularly.
- Assess cardiovascular risk factors.
- Monitor oedema, renal function and GI symptoms.
- Gout: limit 120 mg dose to 8 days.
- Assess pain relief.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Have your BP checked regularly.
- Report chest pain, swelling or breathlessness.
- Take once daily; do not double doses.
- Avoid other NSAIDs.

KEY POINTS

- COX-2 selective; once daily.
- Gout dose 120 mg, max 8 days.
- Raises BP; check before and during use.
- Avoid in heart disease.

SOURCES CHECKED [29] Etoricoxib 120 mg film-coated tablets (UK SmPC)

Full references p. 432–457